

However, it may take some time to master since there are many parameters which require simultaneous adjustment. Use the following steps to convert a picture to black and white in Photoshop.

1. Open this tool by clicking on Image > Adjustments > Channel Mixer in Adobe Photoshop.
2. Be sure to first click on the lower left tick box entitled “Monochrome” for black and white conversion.
3. It is good to get a feel for the distribution of each colour channel by first setting each of the colour channels to 100 per cent individually.
4. Adjust each of the red, green and blue sliders to produce an image to your liking. For an even more pronounced effect, some colours can even have negative percentages.
5. The sum of the red, green and blue percentages need to equal 100% in order to maintain roughly constant brightness, although overall brightness can also be adjusted by using the “Constant” slider at the bottom. If the aim is to mimic the luminosity perceived by the human eye, set the values of Red, Green and Blue at 30%, 59% and 11%, respectively. This technique is particularly elegant because it allows you to apply from any of the entire spectrum of colour filters by just dragging the hue slider. This allows one to quickly assess which combination of colour filters work best, without necessarily having one in mind when starting. It takes a little longer to setup than the channel mixer, but is actually faster to use once in place.
6. Open the image in Photoshop and create two separate “Hue/Saturation Adjustment Layers” by following the menus: Layers > New Adjustment Layer > Hue/Saturation.
7. Each window will be named Hue/Saturation 1 or 2. However, I have given these custom names for this tutorial.